

Figure 5.27 *Lashkari Bazar, South (or Grand) palace, ruins, looking south along Helmand River. © Photograph Josephine Powell* c. *1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

complexes – some undertaken on a grand scale – could be telling indications of the newcomers' occupation of these complexes, we would do well to bear in mind that any shift toward palatial habitation could have been sporadic, and ultimately would have been gradual: after all, ten years can be a momentous period of change in the life of an individual, even as it is virtually invisible in historical time. Perhaps most importantly, any shift from "tent to palace" did not have to be wholesale or irreversible. As captured in the concept of the nomad–urban continuum, nomadic–pastoralist and otherwise transhumant groups became *more* or *less* sedentist depending on prevalent circumstances and other contingencies (cf. Introduction and Chapter 2).

In the face of a discernibly growing tendency toward palace dwelling among the Ghazna Shansabanis and the possible waning of seasonal migrations in distance and/or frequency, the advantageous "cultural capital" of nomadism was surely not forgotten. For example, the greater